

Learn Web

ale66

Digital typography

Last week

- we edited a `lorem.html` file which, once loaded into a browser, generated a *presentation* of Cicero's immortal De finibus essay.
 - Notepad (Win) or Notes (iOS) let us edit the content, somewhat
 - VS Code will support us in the creativity
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WYSIWYG

What You See Is What You Get is the point with MS Word etc.

- one software for all: readers and writers
 - the file is in a proprietary format and not intended for
 - sharing
 - automated modification, e.g., logo injection
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interpretation

- prepare `myarticle.html` with editing software
 - load it into a browser to see the rendered version
 - in effect, we are **coding for the browser**
 - notice: the browser will make a private copy of our file inside its own memory segment: **reload to see changes**
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- the disconnect between writer and reader is typical of the *printed* culture

- infinite replication and delivery is digital
- the HTML/CSS/JSS language standard let us *program browsers*
- we study them to achieve fluency (autonomy) but also to understand their limits

Your own digital publisher

Installations

See the guide from last week

- install VS code
- inside it, install useful extensions

Set up

- on own computer, create a new folder
- inside it create a new `file.html` file.
- (no spaces in names, ever)
- right-click and associate it to VS Code
- double-click and let's start

Boilerplate

- thanks to the [HTML boilerplate](#) extension the basic setup comes in, we will study it later.
- copy/paste Cicero's text to it, then try out HTML annotations to edit it
- this is a creativity task

HTML editing

- don't touch the boilerplate text
- deploy
 - `<b></b>`
 - `<i></i>`
 - `<em></em>`
 - `<strong></strong>`

Reference: [Formatting](#) unit on W3schools.

More editing

- try out nesting:
 - `<b><strong></strong></b>` vs `<strong><b></b></strong>`
 - `<del><em></em></del>`: overblown?

Parsers (the software that analyses our code before executing it) expect us to always close the last/closest tag available: `<b><strong></b></strong>` is **wrong**

Structuring

Paragraphs

- the *para.* (two or more related sentences) is a key to *readability*
- use extra space/lines between paragraph to make your source code readable and easy to maintain.

```
<p>I'm a para. I sit well alone.</p>

<p>I'm a sibling para.
  I also sit well alone.</p>
```

See the [Paragraphs](#) section of W3schools

Headings

- Traditional HTML supports textbook structures, essentially: chapter, section etc.
- linear reading + hierarchy
- HTML5 better supports **articles**

See the [Headings](#) section of W3schools

Exercise

Content inform form

- deploy the Boilerplate and the Preview extensions of VS Code to work on a presentation for Cicero's Lorem.
- Assume a target reader:
 - historian
 - student of Latin
 - Philosopher

and prepare the page for them.